

MAR657: Visual Analytics

Assignment 1: Data Visualization – Foundations and Theories

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Introduction

This assignment explores how Gestalt Principles of Visual Perception and preattentive cues are applied in real-world digital and product designs. I selected five examples—Crunchyroll, Spotify, Walmart, Apple, and Nike—that demonstrate how these principles shape user experience by organizing visual information, reducing cognitive load, and guiding attention toward key actions.

1. Crunchyroll (Anime Streaming Platform)

Gestalt Principles:

- Proximity - anime thumbnails are grouped in rows like “Trending Now.”
- Similarity - thumbnails are the same size and shape, so users instantly know how to browse.
- Figure-ground - dark background makes posters stand out.

Effect: This structure makes browsing a large content library feel simple and prevents visual overload.

Preattentive Cues: Bright orange CTAs (“Watch Now,” “Try Premium”) immediately catch the eye, making navigation clear even for new users.

Crunchyroll

NewPopularSimulcastCategories

SearchBookmarks

THE MOVIE
DEMON SLAYER
INFINITY CASTLE

Exclusively in Theatres in 2025

GET TICKETS

Top Picks for You











Crunchyroll

NewPopularSimulcastCategories

SearchBookmarks

Top Picks for You



Gachiakuta
Sub | Dub



Clevatess
Sub | Dub



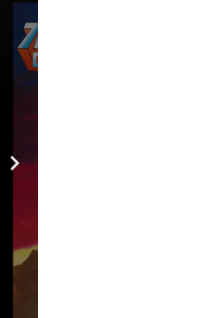
Secrets of the Silent Witch
Sub | Dub



Uglymug, Epicfighter
Subtitled



Detective Conan
Sub | Dub



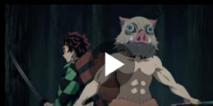
ORG
Sub | Dub

Continue Watching



1m left

DEMON SLAYER: KIMETSU NO YAIBA INFINITY CASTLE
Demon Slayer: Kimetsu no Yaiba Infinity Castle | Trailer
Dub | Sub



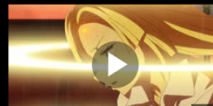
4m left

DEMON SLAYER: KIMETSU NO YAIBA
E16 - Letting Someone Else Go First
Dub | Sub



18m left

APOCALYPSE BRINGER MYOGHIRA: WORLD CONQUEST S...
E9 - It's Well Past Your Bedtime
Subtitled



23m

I WAS REINCARNATED AS THE 7TH PRINCE SO I CAN TAKE...
S2 E22 - Black Dragon
Subtitled



VIEW HISTORY

GACHIAKUTA
E1 - The Sphere
Dub | Sub

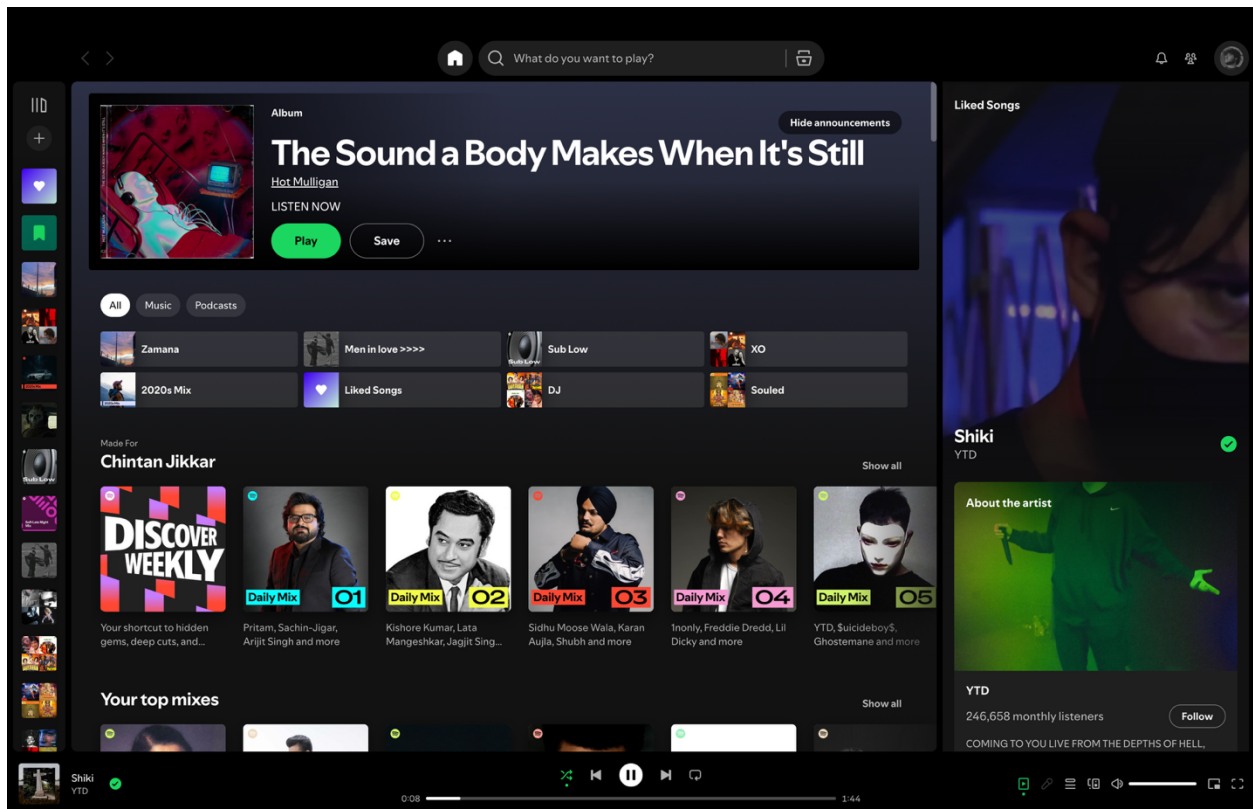
2. Spotify (Music Streaming)

Gestalt Principles:

- Similarity - square album covers with uniform size.
- Continuity - vertical scrolling directs the eye smoothly.
- Proximity - grouping of playlists (e.g., “Made for You”) makes categories clear.

Effect: The design feels consistent and intuitive, encouraging seamless exploration.

Preattentive Cues: Album art with vivid colors, bold section titles, and similar section background colors all stand out instantly, drawing users to discover new music.



Spotify interface showing the home screen with various music recommendations and a sidebar on the right.

Top Bar: Search bar with "What do you want to play?", navigation icons, and user profile.

Left Sidebar: Navigation menu with icons for Home, Library, and other features.

Main Content Area:

- Top Mixes:** A row of six mix cards: Lata Mangeshkar Mix, Atif Aslam Mix, Hip Hop Mix, Pop Mix, 2010s Mix, and Romantic Mix.
- Recently played:** A row of six cards: Liked Songs, Zamana, XO, 2020s Mix, simon riley | ghost edits, and Sub Low.
- Jump back in:** A row of six cards: Pop Mix, HOT HITS, Chai & Classics, and others.

Right Sidebar:

- Liked Songs:** A section titled "Liked Songs" with a "Show all" link.
- Shiki YTD:** A section for the artist Shiki, featuring a video thumbnail and the text "About the artist".

Bottom Bar: Playback controls for the song "Shiki YTD", including a progress bar, play/pause button, and volume control.

Spotify interface showing a music video player with lyrics and a sidebar on the right.

Top Bar: Search bar with "What do you want to play?", navigation icons, and user profile.

Left Sidebar: "Your Library" section with tabs for Playlists, Podcasts, Albums, and Artists. It lists various playlists like "Liked Songs", "Your Episodes", "Zamana", "XO", "2020s Mix", etc.

Main Content Area:

- Music Video Player:** A large red background with white text displaying the lyrics of the song "I don't wanna, I don't wanna die".

Right Sidebar:

- Queue:** A list of songs in the queue, including "CITY OF ANGELS - LLusion Funk Remix", "RITMO DE TREINO", "WE ROLLIN", etc.
- Now playing:** A section titled "Now playing" showing the current song "CITY OF ANGELS - LLusion Funk Remix" by 24kGoldn, LLusion.

Bottom Bar: Playback controls for the song "CITY OF ANGELS - LLusion Funk Remix", including a progress bar, play/pause button, and volume control.

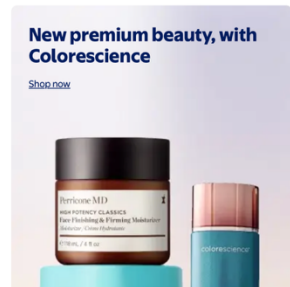
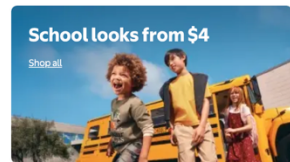
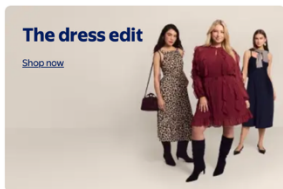
3. Walmart (Retail Website)

Gestalt Principles:

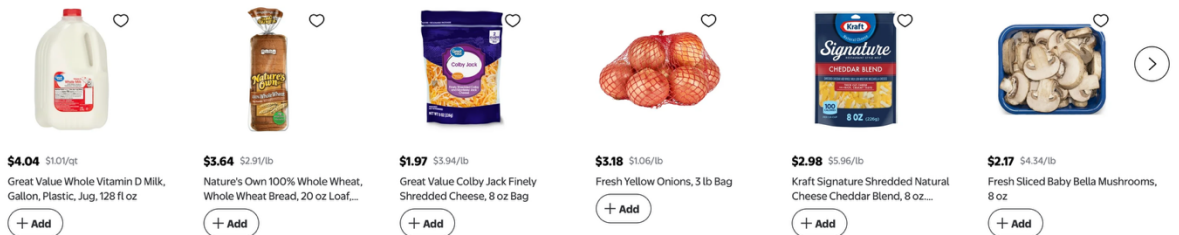
- Common region - product cards are boxed in tiles, clearly separating items.
- Proximity - related offers/products are grouped together.
- Closure - promotional banners often use partial shapes the brain completes.

Effect: These elements help customers compare products quickly and spot promotions easily.

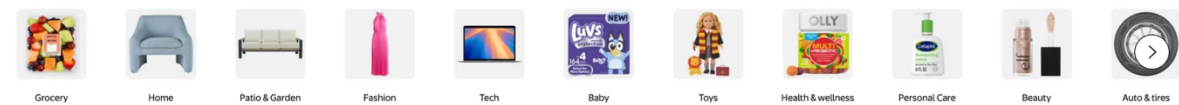
Preattentive Cues: Large price tags and Walmart's blue-and-yellow branding highlight key deals and calls-to-action.



Reorder your essentials



Get it all right here



Hottest Halloween decor

Grab 'em before they vanish...

[View all](#)

Frightful faves

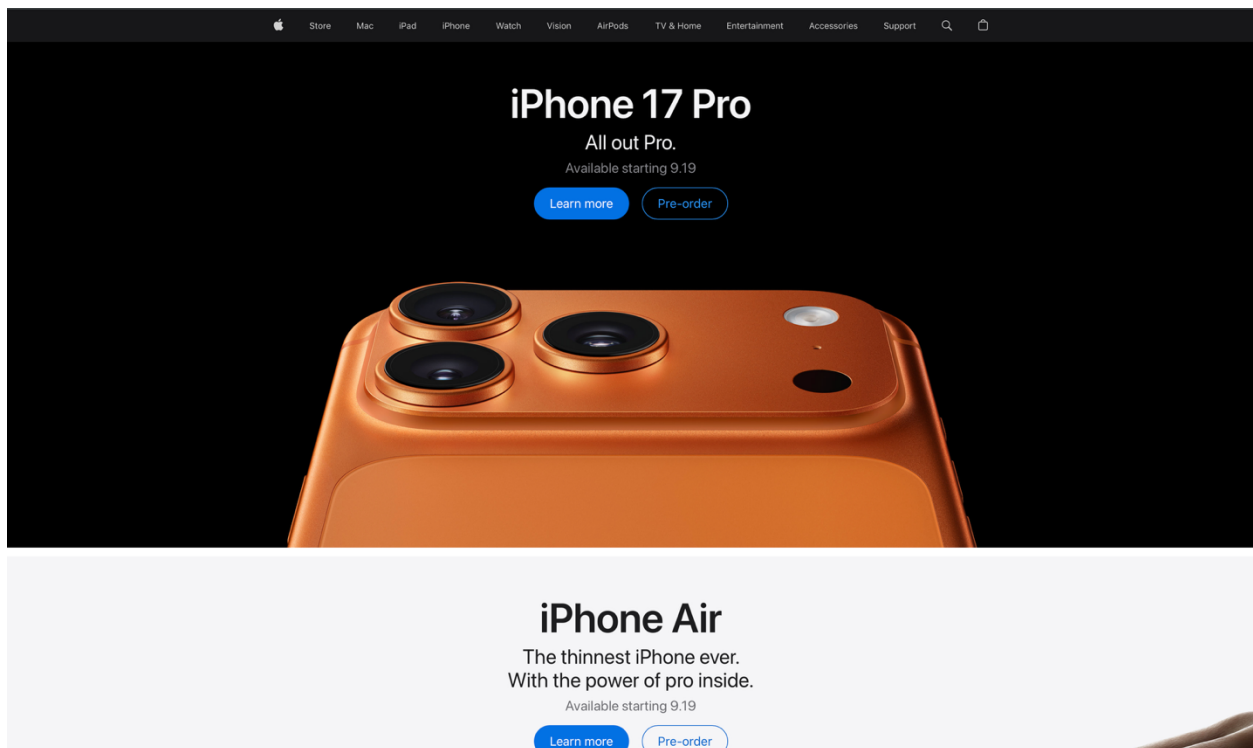
4. Apple (Homepage)

Gestalt Principles:

- Figure-ground - strong white space isolates products.
- Symmetry - centered layouts create balance and harmony.
- Proximity - product name, tagline, and CTA button are grouped tightly for clarity.

Effect: The design draws attention to the product first, supporting Apple's premium brand identity.

Preattentive Cues: Sharp contrasts (e.g., black devices on white) and oversized visuals guide attention before text is read.



AirPods Pro 3

The world's best in-ear
Active Noise Cancellation.

Available starting 9.19

[Learn more](#)

[Pre-order](#)



WATCH SERIES 11

The ultimate way to watch your health.

Available starting 9.19

[Learn more](#)

[Pre-order](#)



WATCH SE 3

WATCH ULTRA 3

Personal beast.

Available starting 9.19

[Learn more](#)

[Pre-order](#)



5. Nike (E-commerce & Branding)

Gestalt Principles:

- Similarity - product photos arranged consistently in grids.
- Closure - swoosh logo suggests motion without being a full shape.
- Figure-ground - minimalist backgrounds make shoe colors stand out.

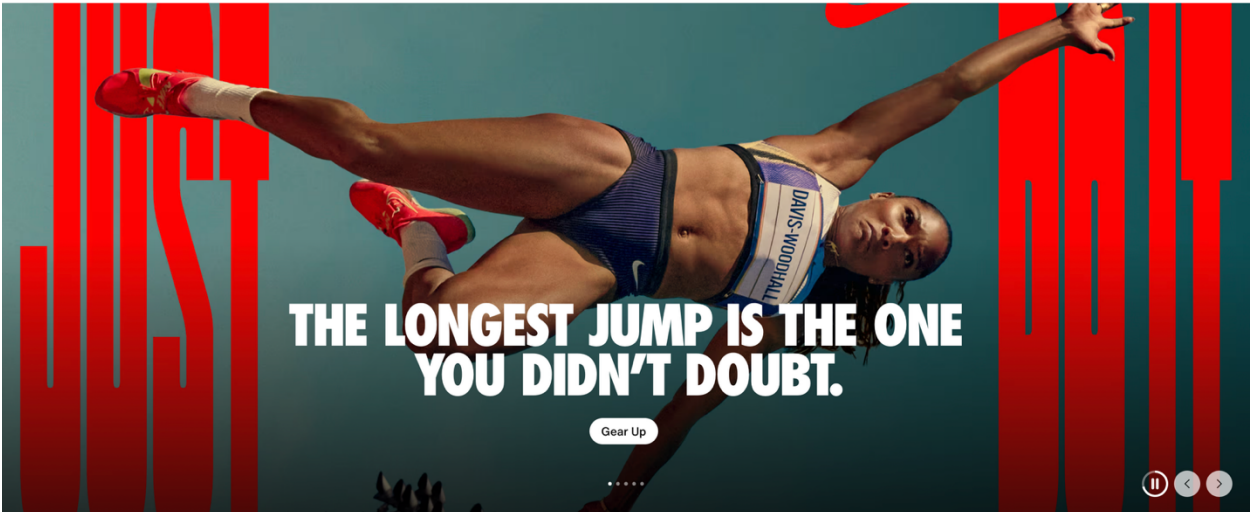
Effect: Browsing is streamlined, and the branding is instantly recognizable.

Preattentive Cues: Black “Add to Cart” buttons, along with bold shoe colors, grab user attention immediately due to strong color contrast.



New Men Women Kids Jordan Sport

Search



Mens Shoes (491)

Hide Filters Sort By

Pick Up Today

- Jordan
- Lifestyle
- Running
- Basketball
- Training & Gym
- Walking
- Soccer
- Skateboarding
- ACG
- Football
- Tennis
- Golf
- Baseball
- Boots
- Sandals & Slides
- Track & Field
- Nike By You
- Lacrosse
- Wrestling

- Gender (1)
- Sale & Offers
- Color
- Shop by Price
- Size (1)



Nike V5 RNR "Denim"
Men's Shoes
\$95



Best Seller
Nike Gato LV8
Men's Shoes
\$115



Nike Gato
Men's Shoes
\$97.97 \$115 14% off
New Markdown



Conclusion

Across all five examples, Gestalt Principles help structure visual information in ways that make content more accessible and engaging. Proximity, similarity, and figure-ground appear most frequently, showing their importance in organizing layouts and emphasizing focus. Meanwhile, preattentive cues such as color, size, and contrast guide user attention almost instantly, making designs both functional and persuasive. Together, these elements demonstrate how visual perception theories are directly applied to enhance customer experience.